



Faculty and Staff Handbook

Effective July 1, 2025

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1. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE OF FACULTY AND STAFF HANDBOOK

Welcome to Monument Academy (“Monument Academy” or the “School”). We are glad that you have chosen Monument Academy as your employer. We would like to thank you in advance for the positive change you will make in the lives of children in Washington, DC. This Faculty and Staff Handbook (this “Handbook”) contains applicable Monument Academy policies and procedures and an overview of Monument Academy’s benefits.

Monument Academy reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to modify or terminate the policies set out in this Handbook at any time, with or without prior notice to employees. Every effort will be made to inform employees of any changes to this Handbook in a timely manner. The School will also make the current published version of this Handbook available in Paycom.

The material in this Handbook is presented for information purposes only and does not constitute a promise or a contract and is not legally binding. Nothing in this Handbook is intended to alter the at-will employment relationship between Monument Academy and its employees.

Each employee should read and become familiar with the information contained in this Handbook. Failure to comply with Monument Academy’s policies or procedures, whether contained in this Handbook, available in Paycom, or otherwise, may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination. Each employee should also read and be familiar with the Monument Academy Student and Family Handbook.

The policies and procedures contained in this Handbook become effective on the date of publication and shall not apply retroactively. This Handbook supersedes all prior versions published or distributed by Monument Academy and all previous oral or written statements concerning the policies and procedures contained herein.

Please keep this Handbook in a convenient place for easy reference. Please discuss any unclear items contained in this Handbook with the CEO or with the COO.

Once again, thank you for choosing to dedicate your skills and commitment to the students and families we serve at Monument Academy.

Sincerely,

Dr. Jeffrey F. Grant

Dr. Jeffrey F. Grant
CEO

2. AT-WILL EMPLOYMENT RELATIONSHIP

Monument Academy is an at-will employer. This means that regardless of any provision in this Handbook, either you or Monument Academy may terminate the employment relationship at any time, for any reason, with or without cause or advance notice. Should employees decide to terminate their employment with Monument Academy, the School encourages employees to provide their supervisor with at least 2 weeks advance notice. Nothing in this Handbook or in any document or statement, written or oral, however, shall limit the right to terminate employment-at-will. The at-will nature of the employment relationship cannot be altered or modified except upon a written agreement signed by the applicable employee and either the Chair of the Board of Directors of Monument Academy or the CEO.

Upon request, the Human Resources Department will confirm former employees' dates of employment, salary history and job title(s). Employees should notify Monument Academy if their address changes during the calendar year in which termination occurs, so that tax information is sent to the proper address.

3. MISSION STATEMENT

Our mission is to empower students, particularly those who have experienced significant adversity, including involvement or risk of involvement in child welfare and/or other social service systems with the requisite academic, social, emotional and life skills to be successful in college, career and community. In addition, we aim to create an outstanding school that attracts, supports, and retains exceptional and caring people.

4. PHILOSOPHY

Our philosophy for educating our students is rooted in a belief that all students have the capacity to succeed at high academic levels and experience positive life outcomes. While many students may have been subject to adverse childhood experiences, these events do not define who they are or predetermine their trajectories.

We also believe in a growth mindset, where adults and students value hard work, persistence, and the process of learning, and understand that valuing dedication and effort, not "talent" and "fixed ability," foster a love of learning and improved outcomes both academically and personally.

Our School is designed with an emphasis on personalized learning, experience-based learning, and social-emotional well-being to ensure that students with disabilities or who are English Language Learners will benefit from our School.

5. THE MONUMENT WAY

Developmentally Focused: You recognize and work from the evidence-based understanding that all children have the same basic requirements for growth and development, but progress varies from child to child, in part based on their life experiences. Your work is to meet children where they are developmentally, and provide the additional support and healing experiences that help them through whatever events may have impeded their development.

Family Involved: You respect and include a child's ethnic, racial and cultural identity and involve guardians and mentors in the student's education and school experience. Family focused involvement obtains the most positive outcomes for students.

Relationship Based: You build relationships with students and staff. You recognize that relationships are the most significant predictor of success for students, and model this in your relationships with peers. You help them develop competencies that build their trust and effectiveness in forming meaningful relationships throughout their lives.

Competence Centered: You help children and your peers become competent (combination of skills, knowledge and attitude to negotiate effectively). For students, you motivate them to master academics and their environment, and motivate them to cope with challenges and master new skills. For peers, you motivate them to improve their skills and relationships.

Trauma Informed: You demonstrate an understanding and practice based in the understanding that children who have a history of violence, abuse, and neglect experience debilitating effects on their growth and development and benefit from activities, routines, expectations and interactions that take this into account. You maintain an environment with a culture of nonviolence and safety so that children feel safe and can learn new responses to stressful situations.

Ecologically Oriented: You create an environment and opportunities that help each child grow and develop, and communicate a belief in the child's own strengths and abilities.

Operating with Integrity: Be transparent and truthful in your interactions with students and other staff.

Using a Lens of Positivity for Self and Others: Assume good intentions and seek to understand. You do not rush to judgment, but ask for clarification and information.

Mindful and Present: When you are working with staff and students, you are focused on them.

Kindness: Showing kindness to one another through communication and actions.

Modeling Excellence: Work hard to continually improve.

6. LETTER FROM THE FOUNDER

Welcome to the Monument Academy Team. We are here because we want to radically transform outcomes for the most vulnerable youth in the city, many of whom are engaged in the child welfare system. We want to support them in the goal of attaining a post-secondary education, a career and a life of independence and self-sufficiency. You may have noticed that part of our mission statement also includes “to create an outstanding school that attracts, supports, and retains exceptional and caring staff.” We did that very deliberately because we think that each one of you is dedicated to our mission and deserving of a great workplace. We hired you because we believe that you share this mission and have the qualities and capacity to be successful and we are committed to supporting you in your work. All of us, including students, are successful when each of us is successful. We are committed to maintaining a workplace of physical and emotional safety for children and adults, and this is reflected in the policies and practices that we are all expected to maintain throughout our program. We aspire to be a place of hard work, learning, joy, and celebration for every member of the community.

Congratulations on joining our team and we look forward to working side by side in the months and years ahead.

Sincerely,

Emily Bloomfield

Emily Bloomfield
Founder

7. BEST PRACTICES FOR WORKING WITH STUDENTS

- In order to protect Monument Academy staff, volunteers, and program participants, at no time during a Monument Academy program may a staff/volunteer person be alone with a single child where they cannot be observed by others. Staff/volunteers supervising children should space themselves in a way that other staff/volunteers can see them. Circumstances such as counseling and/or coaching sessions in which confidentiality must be enforced are the only exception to this rule. This exception is for authorized personnel only and proper scheduling and notification of such sessions are available for other staff/volunteers to see.
- Staff/volunteers shall never leave a child unsupervised.
- Staff/volunteers will make sure a restroom is not occupied before allowing children to use the facilities. Staff/volunteers will stand in the doorway while children are using the restroom. If staff/volunteers are assisting younger children, doors to the facility must remain open.
- Staff/volunteers will conduct and supervise private activities (putting on bathing suits, showering, etc.), at a safe distance (i.e- outside of the restroom door) in pairs. When this is not feasible, staff/volunteers should be positioned so that they are visible to others.
- Staff/volunteers shall not abuse children or use corporal punishment of any kind. This includes physical abuse, verbal abuse, sexual abuse, mental abuse, or neglect. Any type of abuse will not be tolerated and is cause for dismissal.
- Staff/volunteers will respect children's rights to not be touched in ways that make them feel uncomfortable. A child's right to say "No" is to be encouraged and respected. Children are not to be touched in areas of their bodies that would be covered by a bathing suit.
- Staff/volunteers will use appropriate touch including pats on the back or shoulder, side hugs, handshakes, and highfives. Staff/volunteers will refrain from full frontal hugging, touching of personal areas, or patting of the buttocks.
- Staff/volunteers will use positive techniques of guidance, including redirection, positive reinforcement, and encouragement rather than competition, comparison, and criticism.
- Staff/volunteers will not give gifts or special favors to individual children, or show preferential treatment to a child or group of children to the exclusion of others.
- Staff/volunteers will not have private interactions through social media, computer or handheld devices with any children.
- Staff/volunteers will respond to children with respect and consideration and treat all children equally, regardless of gender, race, religion, sexual identity, or culture.
- Staff/volunteers will refrain from intimate displays of affection towards others in the presence of children, parents, and staff.
- Using, possessing, or being under the influence of alcohol or drugs during working hours

is prohibited.

- Smoking or use of tobacco in the presence of children or parents during working hours is prohibited.
- Profanity, inappropriate jokes, sharing intimate details of one's personal life, and any kind of harassment is prohibited.
- Staff/volunteers may not be alone with children they meet in Monument Academy programs outside of Monument Academy. This includes babysitting, sleepovers, and inviting children to their home. Any exceptions require a written explanation before the fact and are subject to administrator approval.
- Staff/volunteers are not to transport children in their own vehicles.
- Staff/volunteers may not date students.
- Under no circumstances should staff/volunteers release children to anyone other than the authorized parent, guardian, or other adult authorized by the parent or guardian (written parent authorization on file with Monument Academy).
- Staff/volunteers are required to report any suspicion of child abuse to the proper authorities and are required to read and sign all policies relating to identifying, documenting and reporting child abuse and attend prevention training.

8. EMPLOYMENT OVERVIEW

8.1. Statement on Equal Employment Opportunity

Monument Academy is an equal opportunity employer and complies with all applicable federal, district, state, and local fair employment practices laws. Monument Academy values diversity and is committed to guaranteeing equal opportunity in the workplace. All policies, procedures, and terms or conditions of employment, including, but not limited to, recruiting, hiring, assigning work, compensation, benefits, training, promotion, transfer, and termination, are administered for all employees and job applicants without regard to race, color, religion, national origin, age, sex, marital status, personal appearance, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, family responsibilities, genetic information, disability, matriculation, political affiliation, or any other protected characteristic under applicable federal, district, state, or local law (referred to as "protected status").

Monument Academy complies with applicable laws protecting job applicants and employees with disabilities. Monument Academy will make reasonable accommodations for qualified individuals with known disabilities unless doing so would result in an undue hardship or a direct threat to safety. Employees who need a reasonable accommodation should submit a request in writing to the Human Resources Department.

8.2. No Discrimination or Harassment

Monument Academy strictly prohibits discrimination and harassment directed toward any employee, student or other person with whom Monument Academy has a professional or business relationship. Any form of discrimination or harassment related to an individual's protected status is a violation of this policy and will result in discipline, up to and including termination.

Monument Academy is committed to maintaining a professional work environment that is free from unlawful discrimination and harassment, including, but not limited to sexual harassment, whether in the office or in other work-related settings. Monument Academy prohibits discrimination and harassment of one employee by another employee, supervisor or manager, or a third party based on an individual's protected status.

Harassment is any offensive action directed at a person's protected status. Some examples of prohibited conduct directed at a person's protected status include, but are not limited to:

- Offensive verbal conduct, such as foul language, jokes, slurs, derogatory comments, or lyrics;
- Unwelcome sexual advances, such as requests for sexual favors, unwanted touching, or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature;
- Offensive visual conduct, such as posting or circulating offensive written or visual material, including pictures, cartoons, drawings, photographs, emails, videotape, internet programs, or websites;
- Offensive physical conduct, such as touching, staring, or blocking movements; or
- Any other threatening or intimidating acts related to an individual's protected status or his or her reporting a violation of this policy.

Any person found to be in violation of this policy shall be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

8.3. Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment may include many forms of offensive behavior and gender-based harassment of a person of the same or different sex as the harasser, whether committed by another employee, a supervisor or manager, or a third party with whom Monument Academy has professional or business relationships. Examples of prohibited conduct include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Explicitly or implicitly offering preferential treatment with regard to an individual's employment status in exchange for sexual favors or sexual activity;

- Making or threatening reprisals after a negative response to sexual advances;
- Deliberate, repeated or unsolicited leering, sexual gesturing, or teasing;
- Displaying of sexually suggestive objects, pictures, cartoons, or posters;
- Verbal conduct that includes making or using derogatory comments, epithets, slurs, or jokes;
- Unwelcome or unwanted sexual advances or propositions;
- Graphic verbal commentaries about an individual's body, sexually degrading words used to describe an individual, or suggestive or obscene letters, notes, emails, or invitations;
- Physical conduct that includes touching, assaulting, or impeding or blocking movements; and
- Unsolicited verbal or physical conduct which has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.

All sexual advances (overt or otherwise) between staff and students are prohibited, on or off the grounds, regardless of the student's age. Romantic or sexual relationships between students and employees, or students and adult family members of employees, are strictly prohibited and will lead to the employee's dismissal.

Anyone in violation of Monument Academy's policy regarding harassment (including sexual harassment) or unlawful discrimination will be subject to disciplinary, up to and including termination.

8.4. Complaint and Reporting Procedure

If an employee experiences or witnesses sexual or other unlawful harassment or discrimination in the workplace, he or she must report it immediately to his/her supervisor. If the incident involves your supervisor is not resolved satisfactorily, the reporting chain is as follows:

1. Department Head
2. Human Resources Specialist
3. COO
4. CEO
5. Board of Trustees

All allegations of unlawful harassment or discrimination will be promptly and thoroughly investigated. All complaints or reports will be kept confidential, to the extent possible.

Monument Academy is committed, and may be required by law, to take action if it learns of potential harassment or discrimination, even if the aggrieved employee or student does not wish to formally file a complaint.

The employee complaining of or reporting unlawful harassment or discrimination is expected to also file an incident report with the School. To file an incident report, please log into your Paycom account and complete the document entitled “Employee Incident Report.” You will be asked to submit the report either for yourself or for another employee (whose name can be typed in). Once the form has been completed and submitted, it will go to the appropriate supervisor to be reviewed and signed off on. Finally, it will be sent to Human Resources for filing.

It is a violation of Monument Academy’s policy to retaliate against a Monument Academy community member for making a good-faith complaint of harassment or for participating in the investigation of a complaint. This prohibition on retaliation extends to individuals who themselves are not complainants, but who participate in an investigation, for example, as witnesses or investigators. If a community member believes he or she has been retaliated against for making or assisting in the investigation of a complaint or report, contact the CEO, COO, or Human Resources Specialist immediately. Any community member who becomes aware of retaliatory conduct must immediately advise the CEO, COO, or Human Resources Specialist so the conduct can be investigated in a timely and confidential manner. Anyone who is found after appropriate investigation to have engaged in a violation of this policy will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

8.5. Child Protection Policy and Mandatory Reporting of Child Abuse and Neglect

Monument Academy has a moral and legal obligation to safeguard children and youth and to maintain a safe and caring community that is free from physical, sexual, and emotional abuse and neglect. Monument Academy will not tolerate abuse of a child or youth.

Employees of Monument Academy are required to comply with this expectation in spirit and in action and to adhere to the guidelines set forth below.

- Employees of Monument Academy shall not engage in or condone the physical, sexual, or emotional abuse or neglect of a child or youth;
- Employees of Monument Academy shall participate in training programs addressing the prevention of child abuse and neglect;
- Employees of Monument Academy shall immediately report any inappropriate behavior or possible violations of this policy; and
- Employees of Monument Academy shall comply with their responsibility under District of Columbia law to promptly report any known or suspected abuse or neglect of a child or youth first to the appropriate Monument Academy official. All mandatory reporters may, at their discretion, proceed to make direct contact with the Child and Family Services Agency (CFSA), and/or the Metropolitan Police Department, as needed.

Mandatory Reporters: The District of Columbia identifies certain categories of persons including, but not limited to, teachers and school officials, nurses, law enforcement officers, day care workers, coaches, mental health professionals, and other key professionals as Mandatory Reporters for purposes of reporting known or suspected child abuse and neglect to appropriate authorities.

As a matter of Monument Academy policy, all other members of the Monument Academy community are required to report any suspected or known instances of child abuse to their direct supervisor and Director of Well-Being and Student Services along with CFSA.

Any allegations made that meet the criteria for mandated reporting must be reported to CFSA within 24 hours. If the allegation is toward a staff member, the employee will be placed on paid administrative leave while the school completes an internal investigation independent of a possible CFSA investigation. CFSA generally updates those involved within 48 hours. Accusations do not guarantee disciplinary action or termination; Monument Academy reserves the right to make a decision regarding disciplinary action upon the completion of the School's investigation.

8.6. Employment Eligibility Verification Compliance Policy

Monument Academy is committed to employing only persons who are legally authorized to work in the United States. Monument Academy does not unlawfully discriminate on the basis of citizenship or national origin. All employees must prove authorization to work in the United States in compliance with the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986 ("IRCA"). Each new employee, as a condition of employment, must complete the Employment Eligibility Verification Form I-9 and present proper documentation establishing identity and employment eligibility. Such documentation must be presented by the employee within 3 business days of hire or on the first day of any employment that is less than 3 business days. Former employees who are rehired must also complete the Form I-9 if they have not completed it with Monument Academy within the past 3 years or if their previous I-9 is no longer retained or valid. Current employees whose work authorization has expired also will be required to complete a new I-9 form.

8.7. Background Checks

Monument Academy conducts two mandatory background checks on prospective and current employees to help avert future problems by identifying applicants or employees who (1) could pose a threat to children or staff members and hence to the School and its mission and (2) who otherwise are not suitable for employment in their positions. One is a fingerprint check done via the FBI and the second is done via a contracted third-party. Background checks may include verification of social security number, education, employment history, military service, professional licenses or certifications, residence(s), criminal record, motor vehicle records,

financial records, employment references, drug screening, and other background information as permitted by law. Charter schools are mandated to rerun background checks on all employees every two years. Monument Academy reserves the right to request a background check at any time.

Any misrepresentation, falsification, or material omission of information presented in the employment application/resume or at any point during the hiring process or during employment may result, as permitted by law, in exclusion of the individual from further consideration for employment at Monument Academy or, if the person has been hired, may result in termination of employment.

A background check result revealing activity that renders an applicant or employee unsuitable for his or her position will be grounds for denying an applicant an offer of employment and for discipline – as permitted by law and as determined by the Human Resources Department or CEO – up to and including termination of any current employee.

All employees are subject to a background check in accordance with The National Child Protection Act of 1993, Pub. L. 103-209 -- Dec. 20, 1993, and the Amendment of the National Child Protection Act and other applicable laws. All background checks conducted by Monument Academy will be in accordance with all applicable federal, district, state, and local laws.

Additionally, in accordance with DC's School Safety Omnibus Amendment Act of 2018, as a school we are required to review the employment history of all applicants where the scope of employment involves direct interaction with children.

8.8. New Employee Orientation Policy

Generally, new employees receive an orientation within the first few weeks of employment at Monument Academy. Employees who join for the start of a new academic year will receive orientation as part of the all-staff professional development sessions over the summer. For other employees, the employee's supervisor shall arrange for an orientation, which may occur in the evenings or on weekends in addition to regular work hours once the school year has started. Orientation for mid-year hires may be consolidated, as appropriate, which may in turn delay the timing of orientation for some new employees. The purpose of the orientation is to ensure that new employees receive a positive start to their work at Monument Academy, feel comfortable in their new working environment, and receive any mandatory certifications. During the orientation, new employees will be given an opportunity to review and ask their supervisor or the Human Resources Specialist any clarifying questions the employee may have regarding the policies and procedures set forth in this Handbook. An up-to-date copy of the Handbook is always accessible in the Paycom system and the shared Google drive..

Whether a formal orientation has been conducted or not, each new employee will be expected to electronically sign the "Acknowledgment & Receipt of Understanding" form which

acknowledges he or she has received and read this Handbook. The signed acknowledgement will be placed in the employee's personnel file. When revisions are made to this Handbook, Monument Academy may require employees to sign a new "Acknowledgement & Receipt of Understanding," acknowledging those changes, which will also be placed in the employee's personnel file. Internal employees who have changed job roles at Monument Academy will be provided with a modified orientation as deemed necessary.

9. EMPLOYMENT CLASSIFICATIONS

An employee is a person employed by Monument Academy to perform services in exchange for remuneration. Independent contractors are not employed by Monument Academy and are not employees. Persons who are not employees of Monument Academy cannot participate in any employee benefits plans that may be sponsored or provided by Monument Academy.

Employees are classified as follows:

- **Non-Exempt Employees:** Includes all full-time and part-time employees of Monument Academy who are covered by the Fair Labor Standards Act ("FLSA") and similar state or local laws and are statutorily entitled to overtime for hours worked in excess of 40 hours per week. Non-exempt employees must accurately and completely record all time worked by clocking in and out on Paycom's website time clocks. Employees will be compensated for all time worked as required by federal, district, state, or local law as applicable. Non-exempt employees are required to submit timesheets for each pay period, approved by the appropriate supervisor, for the purpose of tracking hours worked and calculating compensation. This process takes place within Paycom time and attendance and the payroll provider.

Non-exempt employees working 8 hours or more in a day may take two 15 minute paid breaks per day, one in the morning and one in the afternoon. These break periods are not cumulative and are forfeited if not taken. In addition, non-exempt employees working 8 hours or more in a day may receive one 30 minute paid meal period based on workload demands.

- **Exempt Employees:** Exempt employees are paid a fixed salary regardless of the number of hours worked and who, by virtue of their job duties, are not entitled to overtime compensation.

Employees are also classified within one of the following three statuses:

- **Full-Time Employees:** Full-time employees are employees who are customarily and regularly scheduled to work a minimum of 35 hours per week. Full-time employees may be eligible to participate in employee benefits plans provided or sponsored by Monument Academy in accordance with the requirements specified within such plans policy documents.

- **Part-Time Employees:** Part-time employees are employees who are customarily and regularly scheduled to work less than 35 hours per week. Part-time employees are not eligible to participate in any employee benefits plans that may be provided or sponsored by the School. However, part-time employees who work 50% time or greater will earn 2 paid sick days over the year; one day is available for use between the start of the school year and December 31st, the remaining is available for use between January and the end of the school year.
- **Temporary Employees:** Temporary employees are employed by Monument Academy for a predetermined start and end date of employment. Temporary employees are not eligible to participate in any employee benefits plans that may be provided or sponsored by the School.

In addition, employees are assigned to one of the following functional groups:

- Senior Executive
- Executive
- Managers
- Academic
- Student Life
- Well-Being and Student Services
- Behavior
- Safety
- Operations

Senior Executive: Composed of the CEO, Principal, COO.

Executive: Executive Team is composed of the senior leadership members of Monument Academy who lead the school's different functional teams: Academic, Well-Being, Student Life, Behavior, Safety and Operations. Comprised of the Chief of Family and Community Engagement (FACE), Chief of Well Being, Data, Systems, and IT Chief, Director of Operations, Director of Student Services, and Development Director

Managers: Composed of the RTI Manager, Manager of Family Engagement and Manager of Student Affairs.

Principal, Chiefs, Directors and Managers: These titles denote responsibility for leading a group of people or a key area of work.

Academic: Academic staff are Monument Academy's instructional team. Academic staff have

teaching qualifications and are responsible for the academic program of the School. Most academic staff will work during the day.

Well-Being: Well-Being staff provide behavioral and therapeutic support for our students. The Well-Being staff is typically licensed professionals in the fields of social work, counseling, and psychology. Well-Being staff may work in overlapping shifts from morning into late evening. Student services staff provide academic support required by student IEPs.

Student & Family Engagement: Student & Family Engagement staff support the engagement of families (parents & guardians), as well as the residential portion of the School's program. This team oversees the student boarding experience, family resource management and parent education.

Behavior: Behavior support staff provide behavioral support and positive rewards (PBIS) for our students. The Behavior staff work to support classrooms and academic staff with behaviors, help create quality FBAs, BIPs, and positive reinforcement plans.

Safety: The Safety team is composed of Safety Specialists. The function of this team is to maintain the security of the facility both internally and externally. This team is trained to ensure the safety of all students and staff.

Operations: Operations staff support the daily operations of the School, including procurement, inventory management, vendor management, facilities maintenance, data, systems, IT compliance and reporting. Administrative support staff assist the leadership team in various functions including recruiting, development, and assessments.

10. COMPENSATION

10.1. Pay Period and Payday

Monument Academy employees are paid two times per month, on the 15th and the last day of the month. If a payday falls on a holiday (when banks would be closed), employees will receive their paycheck on the day before the closure. If you are salaried, your first paycheck will be paid on the first pay date following the start of employment through to that pay date; for example if you start working on the 8th of the month, your first paycheck will be on the 15th for the 8th through 15th of that month. If you are hourly or part-time, your pay will be one week in arrears. For example, if you started on the 2nd of the month, you will be paid on the 15th, however the pay periods end one week prior to the pay date, so you would only be paid through the 8th of the month. You will receive a pay schedule detailing the pay periods and pay dates.

All employees are strongly encouraged to be paid through Monument Academy's direct deposit program. Employees that elect not to participate in direct deposit may be issued a check for wages due each payday. Employees interested in participating in direct deposit should contact the

Human Resources Department. The direct deposit form can be found in Paycom System.

Paycom is our payroll provider and all employees will be set up with the ability to log into their own account where they can view payroll information, pay stubs, and tax forms. Paycom provides paid time off information and timekeeping information that will be discussed later in this handbook.

11. MAINTAINING PERSONNEL RECORDS

Employees are responsible for providing current information regarding their address, telephone number(s), insurance beneficiaries, dependent(s), marital status, etc. Changes in exemptions for tax purposes will only be made upon the receipt of a completed W-4 form.

Employee records are kept confidential. Employee personnel files are the property of the School and do not belong to the employee. Upon request, the School will provide employees with access to view documents in the employee's personnel file that were reviewed or submitted by the employee. Most documents are viewable in Paycom.

12. ATTENDANCE AND ABSENTEEISM

Monument Academy expects all employees to report to work on time and to clock in by their scheduled start time, which will be set in accordance with the employee's supervisor. Reporting to work on time means that you are on post at the assigned time fully prepared to work.

Additionally, Monument expects all employees to clock out at the end of their work day, also set in accordance with the employee's supervisor. Student Life Advisors that live on-site, due to the nature of their work, are exempt from clocking in and out.

In case of unplanned conditions, such as inclement weather that may force a schedule change at the last minute, announcements of School closings or delays in the opening of School will be made on Monument Academy's website, via text blast or google hangouts, and/or on local radio and television stations.

Administrators will email staff and send out text messages/google hangouts if practicable.

Residential staff will be expected to remain on campus when there are unplanned conditions that may require a schedule change or cancellation of classes.

Monument Academy expects all employees to assume responsibility for attendance and promptness. An employee who is frequently absent or tardy and/or absent without notifying his or her supervisor according to protocol may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination. Except under extraordinary circumstances, an employee who is absent without proper notice for three (3) consecutive working days will be considered to have resigned from his or her position. After three (3) days' absence with proper notice, you may be required to provide

documentation from your physician to support an injury- or illness-related absence, and to ensure that you may safely return to work.

13. RECORDING HOURS WORKED

All employees, both exempt and non-exempt, will be expected to clock in and out using the Paycom System each day (except the live-in Student Life Advisors). This will create a timesheet for all employees accurately recording hours worked for each day. These daily records of hours worked will be used to verify hourly time-sheets for non-exempt employees, and to make sure all employees are arriving and leaving at their scheduled times. Failure to clock in and out may lead to a dock in pay and may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination.

13.1. Multiple Roles

Staff are not permitted to work more than one full time role at Monument Academy. While staff may take on additional responsibilities outside of their standard work hours, those hours may not constitute a second full time role at Monument Academy.

Additionally Monument Academy staff may not take on additional work responsibilities either from Monument or external sources during their normal work hours.

Any staff taking on additional responsibilities within a different department will receive performance evaluations from their direct supervisor.

For individuals who live on campus, any additional employment taking place on campus must be disclosed to school leadership and approved prior to commencement. These work opportunities may not involve non Monument Academy community members coming to campus.

13.2. Reasonable Break Time for Nursing Mothers

In recognition of the well documented health advantages of breastfeeding for infants and mothers, Monument Academy provides a supportive environment to enable breastfeeding employees to express their milk during work hours. Breastfeeding employees who choose to continue providing their milk for their infants after returning to work shall receive:

- **Milk Expression Breaks:** Breastfeeding employees are allowed to breastfeed or express milk during work hours using their normal breaks and mealtimes. For time that may be needed beyond the usual break times, employees can coordinate with their supervisor.
- **A Place to Express Milk:** A private room (not a restroom) shall be available for employees to breastfeed or express milk. The room will be private and sanitary, located near an electrical outlet.

14. LEAVE FROM WORK

14.1. Vacation Time

All Monument Academy employees are classified as Direct Service Providers or Indirect Service Providers. Direct Service Providers are defined as staff whose primary roles include working directly with the student population. Indirect Service Providers staff are defined as staff whose primary role does not include working directly with students, or who occupy administrative, leadership and management roles within the organization.

DIRECT SERVICE PROVIDERS

- Teachers
- Teacher Assistants
- School Counselors and Social Workers
- Dedicated Aides
- Interventionists
- Special Education Teachers
- Student Life Advisors
- Student Life Advisor Floaters
- Behavior Specialists
- School Nurse

INDIRECT SERVICE PROVIDERS

- CEO
- Principal
- Chief Operating Officer
- Chief of Family and Community Engagement
- Chief of Well-Being
- Data, Systems and IT Chief
- Development Director
- Director of Operations
- Director of Student Supports

- RTI Manager
- Human Resources Specialist
- Family Engagement Specialist
- Safety Specialists
- Manager of Student Affairs
- Student Life Manager
- Academic Technology Specialist
- IT Security Specialist
- Administrative Assistants

DIRECT SERVICE PROVIDER BREAKS (which include Federal Holidays)

Please refer to the School Calendar for all breaks and holidays. Full time direct staff have 8 Vacation days and 5 Sick days for a total of **13 PTO** days off during the contract school year. There are 185 instructional days and 11 built in PD days for a total of 196 days.

Direct Service Providers

All direct service providers receive the scheduled holidays detailed on the calendar and eight (8) days of Vacation which can be used for personal days and (5) days of Sick leave for full time employees and (2) days for part time employees. All Vacation day requests must be approved in advance by the employee's supervisor. With extreme exception, Sick leave requests should not exceed two(2) consecutive days without proper documentation. **Additionally, Vacation may not be used to extend the weeks of scheduled breaks.** While Monument Academy will try to grant employees' requests for leave, the needs of the School, and workload of the employee will be considered when evaluating an employee's request. Monument Academy reserves the right to grant, deny, or modify any request for Vacation time. Employees should not schedule any Vacation prior to getting approval (including flights, travel plans, etc.). For the benefit of the students and overall school operations, we ask that employees make every attempt to be present when school is in session, and on days in which professional development is scheduled. There are blackout dates for direct service staff which will be communicated by your supervisor (including student testing dates).

INDIRECT SERVICE PROVIDER BREAKS (which include Federal Holidays)

Please refer to the School Calendar for the school closures and holidays. Indirect staff have 12

Vacation days as well as 5 Sick days for a total of **17 PTO** days off during the contract school year.

Indirect Service Providers

All indirect service providers receive the scheduled holidays detailed on the Calendar and (12) days of Vacation time and (5) days of Sick leave. Sick leave requests should not exceed two (2) consecutive days without documentation, where Vacation may be requested for more than three (3) consecutive days, but cannot be used to extend holidays.. There are blackout dates for indirect service staff which will be communicated by your supervisor (including student testing dates). Indirect service staff will meet with their supervisors at the start of the year to schedule planned Vacation as a team to ensure the school is appropriately staffed.

14.2. Vacation Leave Payout Policy

- Live-in Student Life Advisors are paid out at their regular hourly rate for all unused Vacation time up to a maximum of 4 days.
- Indirect service providers must use their allotted Vacation time during the course of the school year or it is forfeited at the end of the contract year on 6/30.
- Direct service providers must use their allotted Vacation time during the course of the school year or it is forfeited at the end of the school year on 6/30.
- There is no payout or annual rollover for Sick leave.
- If Vacation Leave is exhausted, staff can request Unpaid Time Off that is granted at the discretion of your Supervisor.

14.3. Requesting Vacation & Sick Leave

To request Vacation in advance please follow the following process:

- Log in to Paycom time and attendance and submit the requested date(s) as far in advance as possible (two (2) weeks prior for two (2) or more consecutive days)
 - **When requesting a Friday off, you must submit for a full day (8 hours). Failure to submit a request for 8 hours will result in your request being denied.**
- Your supervisor will receive a notification of your request for his/her consideration
- Your supervisor can either approve, deny, or adjust the request
- You will receive notification of your supervisor's decision and your Vacation balance will be updated automatically in Paycom if applicable

To request Sick in an emergency situation (ie. ill, family emergency, etc.), please follow this

process:

- Contact your direct supervisor as soon as possible, but no later than one hour prior to your report time
- Within 24 hours of the absence, log the Sick leave request into Paycom
- Sick leave used in an emergency situation that results in more than two (2) consecutive days out will require a doctor's note or other appropriate documentation
- If Sick Leave is exhausted, staff can request Unpaid Time Off that is granted at the discretion of your Supervisor.

Failure to follow these processes may result in unpaid time off and/or progressive discipline, up to and including termination for multiple offenses.

Accrued but unused Vacation will be forfeited upon termination from employment for any reason. Unused Vacation leave will be paid out per the payout policy after the completion of the contract year to the Student Life Advisors who work through the end of the contract on June 30th. Should the employee or the School terminate the staff member's employment for any reason on a date before the end of the School year, any and all accrued but unused Vacation time will be forfeited and unpaid.

This Vacation policy addresses absences for Vacation leave. It does not cover other absences, such as absences for sick time, parental leave, bereavement leave, or leave under the District of Columbia Family and Medical Leave Act.

14.4. Bereavement Leave

All employees are eligible for three (3) days of paid bereavement leave due to the death of an immediate family member. Employees do not have to use Vacation or Sick leave for the days they are on qualified bereavement leave. An employee that needs to take time off under this policy should notify the supervisor as soon as practicable. For the purposes of this policy, immediate family members include: an employee's spouse, domestic partner, civil union partner, parents, step-parents, parents-in-law, siblings, brothers-in-law, sisters-in-law, children, step-children, sons-in-law, daughters-in-law, grandparents, grandchildren, or any other relatives residing in the employee's home.

14.5. Jury Duty

Monument Academy encourages employees to fulfill their duties related to jury service. All full-time, part-time, and temporary employees are entitled to a maximum of five (5) days of paid time off for jury duty leave. If jury duty service exceeds five (5) days, full-and part-time

employees are entitled to unpaid time off for the additional days spent serving on a jury. In addition, exempt employees may be provided with paid leave when necessary to comply with district and federal wage and hour laws.

An employee requesting jury duty leave shall provide their supervisor with a copy of the jury summons and applicable documents showing the length of jury service performed. These copies shall be given to HR to be placed into the personnel file as documentation for the required absence.

14.6. Military Service Leave

Monument Academy recognizes that employees may need to be absent from work to serve in the United States military or similar state military or militia groups. Monument Academy provides military service leaves of absence to full-time, part-time, or probationary employees in compliance with the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act of 1994 (“USERRA”) and any applicable district laws.

Procedures: An employee who is taking leave under this policy must notify his or her supervisor and give the supervisor copies of the employee’s military orders, or other proof of military obligations, as soon as practicable, unless military necessity prevents such notice or it is otherwise impossible or unreasonable. The employee will be granted a military leave of absence in accordance with applicable federal and district laws.

Compensation During Leave: Military service leave is unpaid. However, employees may use any or all of their accrued but unused vacation or other paid time off during their military service leave of absence.

Benefits During Leave: During military service leave, all benefits provided under an employee benefit plan are governed by the terms and conditions of the applicable employee benefit plan documents in accordance with applicable law. For all other non-seniority benefits, an employee on military leave will receive the same rights and benefits available to employees on non-military leave, whether paid or unpaid.

Reinstatement After Leave: The employee’s eligibility for reinstatement after his or her military service leave of absence is determined in accordance with applicable federal and district laws. If you are eligible for reemployment, you will be reemployed with the same seniority, and all rights and benefits based on that seniority, that you would have attained if you had not taken a military service leave of absence.

Monument Academy will not discriminate or retaliate against any employee or prospective employee with regard to hiring, retention, promotion, or reemployment because of past, present, or future membership, application for membership, or performance of ordered military service in any of the uniformed services. All questions concerning this policy should be directed to

Monument Academy's Senior Manager, Operations.

15. DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA FAMILY AND MEDICAL LEAVE ACT

It is the policy of Monument Academy to comply with the provisions of the District of Columbia Family and Medical Leave Act ("DCFMLA"). Eligible employees may take up to sixteen (16) unpaid, job-protected workweeks of DCFMLA medical leave AND up to sixteen (16) unpaid, job-protected workweeks of DCFMLA family leave in any twenty-four (24) consecutive month period for specified family and medical reasons. To be eligible for DCFMLA leave, an employee must:

- Have worked for Monument Academy at least one year without any break in service, other than regular holiday, sick, or personal leave; and
- Have worked at least 1,000 hours in the twelve (12) months immediately preceding the request for family and medical leave.

Eligible employees may take DCFMLA leave for the following reasons:

- A serious health condition, as defined by the DCFMLA, which makes the employee unable to perform the functions of his or her job;
- Caring for a newborn child or placement of a child with the employee for adoption or foster care; or
- Caring for a family member, as defined by the DCFMLA, with a serious health condition, as defined by the DCFMLA.

Employees who wish to take family and medical leave should contact the Human Resources Department and get further information on the process. To be eligible for family and medical leave, an employee must submit an application found in Paycom to the Principal stating the reason for leave, the duration of the leave, and the starting and ending dates of the leave. All applications are kept confidential and separate from the employee's personnel file. In the event of a foreseeable leave of absence, employees must submit an application 30 days prior to the day they want to start their leave. Monument Academy may delay leave to employees who do not provide proper advance notice of the foreseeable need for leave. If the employee's need is not foreseeable, the employee should give as much notice as is practicable. Your DCFMLA leave runs concurrently with other types of leave, for example, accrued Vacation that is substituted for unpaid DCFMLA leave and any district family leave laws, to the extent allowed by law.

Employees will be required to provide a certification from a health care provider if requesting leave to care for a seriously ill family member or for leave because the employee is unable to perform his or her job due to a serious health condition. The certification must state the date on which the health condition commenced, the probable duration of the condition, and the

appropriate medical facts regarding the condition. A certification form is available from the Human Resources Department and can also be found in Paycom. The employee must give the physician or practitioner a job description. A similar certification will be required for a reduced-hours leave or an intermittent leave due to the employee's health condition or that of a family member. For a reduced-hours leave or intermittent leave, the certification must be completed to state that such a leave is medically necessary, provide the expected duration, and include a schedule of the leave.

Monument Academy may require a second certification at its own expense if it wants to confirm the first medical opinion. Monument Academy may designate or select a physician or practitioner for the second certification. Monument Academy may also require a third certification by a physician or practitioner jointly approved by the employee and Monument Academy, again at Monument Academy's expense, if the first two opinions conflict. This third opinion will be considered binding and exclusive.

Recertification may be required by Monument Academy not more often than every thirty (30) days, upon a request for an extension from the employee, or when Monument Academy has reason to question the validity of the original certification. In addition, Monument Academy may require the employee to obtain a fitness for duty report from his or her physician before returning to work.

Monument Academy may delay or deny approval of leave for lack of proper medical certification.

15.1. Benefits and Return to Work

If an employee qualifies for approved FMLA, Monument Academy will maintain benefits coverage for the employee and (if applicable) his or her family during the employee's family and medical leave. This coverage will be provided in the same manner that the employee or his or her family was covered under the plan before the leave was taken and on the same terms as if the employee had continued to work during that time. The employee is responsible for their portion of the premium and should mail a check or money order for the monthly amount made out to Monument Academy Public Charter School. Monument Academy may recover premiums paid to maintain health coverage for an employee and his or her family if the employee ultimately chooses not to return to work as scheduled and/or doesn't make the required premium payment(s).

Upon returning from family and medical leave, an employee will be restored to his or her original job or to an equivalent job with equivalent pay, benefits, and employment terms and conditions. Employee family medical leave will not result in the loss of any employment benefit that the employee earned or was entitled to before the family medical leave.

However, these benefits will not accrue during an unpaid leave.

15.2. Parental Paid Leave

Maternity/paternity/adoption leave under this policy is paid leave associated with the birth of an employee's own child(ren) or the placement of a child(ren) with the employee in connection with adoption or foster care. Parental leave is not charged against the employee's other paid leave and the amount of paid days received is equal to two (2) weeks. The paid leave is compensated at 100% and pay will occur within the normal payroll practices. Parental leave will run concurrently with DC FMLA and FMLA. If both parents are employees, each parent will receive two (2) weeks but the leave must be scheduled to not run simultaneously. Administration will work with the family to arrange the most effective schedule taking into account all parties' needs. This leave can be used up to ninety (90) days after the birth of the child. After paid maternity/paternity leave is exhausted, the employee is required to apply all other available paid leave, which will also run concurrently with FMLA leave.

15.3. Workers' Compensation

Workers' Compensation insurance is carried by Monument Academy as required by law. Employees are entitled to Workers' Compensation benefits as required by applicable federal, district, state, or local laws. If you are injured on the job, no matter how slightly, report the incident immediately to your supervisor and the Human Resources Department. Please complete the appropriate forms found in Paycom as soon as possible. Failure to report an injury within a reasonable period of time could jeopardize your claim to benefits. The submitted form in Paycom will notify HR and the claim will be filed within 24-48 hours. The carrier will follow up when applicable.

16. EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

Monument Academy may provide or sponsor employee benefit plans. This section of the Handbook provides brief summaries of some of the employee benefit plans sponsored by Monument Academy. More detailed information regarding many of these benefits is contained in plan documents and group insurance policies. Eligibility to participate in, and the terms, conditions, limitations, and benefits of, any employee benefit plan provided or sponsored by Monument Academy are governed by the plan's policy documents. Employees are encouraged to review the official plan documents for further information. Monument Academy reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to modify, amend, or terminate any employee benefit plan in accordance with applicable law. For more information on employee benefit plans please refer to Monument Academy's specific plan documents or contact the Human Resources department.

Monument Academy currently offers the following employee benefit plans:

- Group Health Care
- Dental and Vision Plans
- Supplemental Life Insurance
- Short and Long Term Disability
- Section 125 Plan
- 401K
- Employee Assistance Plan
- Will preparation assistance
- Travel Assistance Program

17. COBRA

The federal Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (“COBRA”) gives eligible employees and their qualified beneficiaries the opportunity to continue health insurance coverage under Monument Academy’s health plan when a qualifying event occurs. Some common qualifying events include resignation; termination of employment; the death of the covered employee; certain reductions in an employee's hours; an employee's divorce or legal separation; or a dependent child no longer meeting eligibility requirements. The period of time for which continued coverage is available depends on the specific qualifying event triggering eligibility.

The plan administrator will notify the individuals eligible for continuation coverage of their right to elect COBRA continuation coverage. For more information regarding COBRA please contact the Human Resources Department.

18. STANDARDS OF CONDUCT

Monument Academy expects that all employees conduct themselves in a professional and ethical manner. Employees should neither conduct business that is unethical in any way, nor should they influence other employees to act unethically. Furthermore, an employee should report any dishonest activities or damaging conduct to an appropriate supervisor. Nothing in this policy is meant to change the at-will nature of the employment relationship between Monument Academy and any employee.

In the event that you become aware of another employee’s behavior or actions which you believe are inappropriate, illegal, problematic, or in any way inhibit or affect your job performance or the Monument Academy work environment, you should discuss or report such behaviors or actions

with your supervisor, the Human Resources Coordinator, COO, or CEO using the procedures set forth herein under the Reporting Policy, the No Discrimination or Harassment and Equal Employment Opportunity Policies, or the Work-Related Grievances policy, as applicable.

You should not discuss such actions or behaviors with other Monument Academy employees. Your discussing such matters with other employees may – in and of itself – create an unacceptable work environment for which you will be held responsible and for which you may be disciplined in accordance with Monument Academy employment policies.

18.1. Dress Code Policy

Monument Academy maintains an environment of professional attire. Staff must wear attire that demonstrates a commitment to serving as role models for our students. Monument Academy is preparing students for college and careers, and as such, our staff must be exemplars of professionalism. Attire should be appropriate for the work related activities in which the employee is engaged. Direct Personnel within the SAFE Department will be required to be in uniform during their tour of duty (uniform compliance details will be listed in the SAFE Standards of Practice). When in doubt, staff should confer with their direct supervisor concerning their clothing. Offenses of the dress code may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination.

Examples of acceptable attire:

- Collared shirts/polo shirts
- Khakis/slacks
- Skirts/dresses
- Monument Academy wear

Examples of unacceptable attire:

- Hats
- Ripped clothing
- T-shirts*
- Spaghetti straps
- Jeans*
- Sweatpants
- Leggings/yoga pants, unless accompanied by a top that fully covers buttocks
- Flip-flops/slides
- Bike shorts

*On Fridays, staff are permitted to wear jeans, as long as they do not have rips or tears and it is accompanied with an appropriate top.

Any employee that requires a reasonable accommodation for reasons based on religion, disability, or other grounds protected by federal, district, state, or local laws should contact their supervisor or the Human Resources Specialist. Reasonable accommodations will be granted unless it would cause an undue hardship on Monument Academy. Nothing in this policy is intended to restrict communications or actions protected or required by federal, district, state, or local law.

18.2. Use of School Property

All School workspaces and furniture/supplies/technology are the property of Monument Academy and must be available to management at all times. The use of personal locks on any School property is strictly forbidden. When any School equipment, including computers, photocopiers or printers is used for personal business, the employee understands that the School has full access to it at any time. Monument Academy property and the material created, received and stored by or transmitted through such equipment, are subject to review and monitoring by the School without notice to employees. In using the School's property, equipment and services, all employees waive any right to privacy with regard to any use of the School's equipment and systems and accept the School's right to monitor this use.

18.3. Postage, Shipping and Office Supplies

Postage, shipping and office supplies paid for by the School are for business purposes only and are not to be used for an employee's personal purposes.

18.4. Personal Property

Monument Academy does not assume responsibility for any personal property including cell phones, laptops, and other technology devices located on its premises (including within the building, the surrounding outdoor area and parking lot). Employees are to use their own discretion when choosing to bring personal property onto campus and do so at their own risk. Monument Academy is not responsible for monitoring or otherwise securing an employee's personal property. Additionally, employees may not bring or display any property that may be viewed as inappropriate or offensive to others.

18.5. Building Security

Employees are responsible for making sure all windows in their work space and student home are closed and locked overnight and when they're not on property. All staff must lock their

classroom or office door when vacant and external doors should never be propped open.

18.6. Visitors

Monument Academy ensures a safe environment for all occupants of the school. It is vital to school safety that we are aware of who enters and exits the building at all times. Regardless of the nature of the visit, all visitors should:

- Enter the building through the main entrance located on 19th Street NE.
- Inform the Safety Specialist or other Monument staff assigned to front desk duties about the visitor's purpose before gaining entrance into the building.
- Provide their ID to the Monument Staff who in turn will note the following information in a visitor ID log book: visitor's name, reason for visiting, and time of entry into the visitor log. The visitor signs next to their name.

Any visitors who will be walking through the building must receive a visitor sticker or lanyard badge that indicates their name, date, and time of visit.

All contractors working in the building should receive a special "Monument-Approved Contractor" lanyard badge that they wear throughout their work.

All lanyard badges must be returned to the Monument Staff at the front desk. Staff should record the visitor's time of departure in the visitor log.

****For Student Life Advisors:** It may be the case that you receive visitors to your student life home on the weekends when there is no one up front to sign them in. All visitors should be pre-announced via email to the Chief or Manager of Student Life and/or the COO. If you have visitors during the front desk's standard operating hours, please have them sign in up front.

18.7. Children in the Workplace

Monument Academy values its employees and recognizes the importance that families fulfill in the lives of employees. The School also has an obligation to its students, faculty, staff, and visitors to conduct its operations and maintain its facilities in a manner consistent with its mission as an institution of higher education.

As a statement of general policy, Monument Academy employees are prohibited from bringing children on campus during work hours without express permission from the CEO. Employees with dependent children are expected to make regular arrangements for proper care of their children while at work. The exception to this general policy is for Student Life Advisors who have a child that resides on School property. In these cases, the child may be present and under the supervision of the parent/guardian.

Supervisors may direct an employee, at their discretion, to remove a child from the workplace

even if prior permission to allow the child in the workplace had been granted.

Monument Academy does not accept any liability for injuries to children who are on campus in violation of this policy.

18.8. Physical Interventions

Monument Academy believes that physical interventions to contain and/or control the behavior of students in our care should only be used to ensure safety and protection. Except where otherwise specified as part of an approved individual crisis management plan, physical interventions will only be employed as a safety response to acute physical behavior and their use is restricted to the following circumstances: the student, other students, staff members or others are at imminent risk of physical harm.

As any physical intervention involves some risk of injury to the young person or staff, staff must assess this risk against the risks involved in failing to physically intervene when it may be warranted. Physical intervention should never increase (or create more) risk than the behavior it is trying to contain.

Physical interventions must never be used as (1) punishments, (2) consequences, or (3) for “demonstrating who is in charge.” Unless approved by the COO, Chief of Operations, Principal, or CEO and specified in an individual crisis management plan, physical interventions must never be used for program maintenance (such as enforcing compliance with directions or rules or for preventing the student from leaving the premises). Physical restraint should never be used for therapeutic purposes.

Physical interventions will only be employed after other less invasive approaches (such as DBT techniques or verbal interventions) have been attempted unsuccessfully, or where there is no time to try such alternatives.

Physical interventions must only be employed for the minimum time necessary. They will cease when the student is judged to be safe and no longer at risk of self-injury or harming others.

Physical interventions may only be undertaken by staff who have successfully completed Crisis Prevention Institute (CPI) training which includes all of the following: (1) crisis definition and theory; (2) the use of de-escalation techniques; (3) crisis communication; (4) anger management; (5) physical intervention techniques; (6) the legal, ethical, and policy aspects of their use; (7) decision-making related to physical interventions; (8) debriefing strategies; (9) signs of distress and effect on the student; and (10) the needs and behaviors of the population served. They must also have demonstrated competency in performing the intervention techniques, which is measured and documented according to relevant professional and/or district regulatory guidelines.

All staff involved in an incident of physical intervention must have successfully completed CPI

training as endorsed and implemented by Monument Academy, been assessed as competent in the use of physical interventions, and have successfully completed a skills review within the previous six months.

Only physical intervention skills and decision-making processes that are taught in the comprehensive CPI course and approved by Monument Academy (and the District of Columbia) may be used. All techniques (including decision-making processes) must be applied according to the guidelines provided in the training and in this policy.

Two or more certified staff members must be involved in any physical intervention to help ensure safety and accountability.

Students are not permitted to restrain or assist in the restraint of other students.

To the extent that it is possible, all additional staff and students should be cleared from the area by an administrator or Safety Specialist team member.

Following any incident involving physical restraint, Monument Academy must ensure that there is a post-incident medical and follow-up evaluation, debriefing and support is offered to the student, the staff members, and any other people involved in or witnesses of the episode. Staff members should provide the student with an explanation for the intervention and offer the student an opportunity to express his or her views on what transpired.

Monument Academy has a formal grievance procedure in place for the students in its care (or their families). See the Student and Family Handbook for more information.

Employees shall report any initial use of physical restraint to Monument Academy on the Physical Intervention Incident Report and an agreed individual crisis management plan will be developed and implemented by the staff, students, and family members. The plan will include positive and less intrusive intervention techniques and specify the circumstances under which physical restraint may or may not be an appropriate response in the future.

If any injury to a student results from the use of physical interventions, the details must be reported to the appropriate district authorities. A formal review of the incident and the individual crisis management plan will follow.

18.9. Staff Transportation of Students

Staff shall not transport students in personal cars, except when providing such transportation is necessary to address a legitimate threat of death, serious injury or unless otherwise approved by the Principal or Director of Safety. Only the Director of Safety, CEO, COO, Principal and preapproved security members may transport students in their personal cars. In all other cases where a student must be transported by Monument Academy, the School will procure the services of a professional driver or arrange a public transportation option for the trip.

18.10. General Policy for Interaction with Law Enforcement/Emergency Personnel

In the event that law enforcement or emergency officials arrive at Monument Academy's campus, employees should refrain from answering any and all inquiries and politely instruct those individuals to wait while the CEO, COO, or Director of Safety is located to address their issues. If none of the aforementioned are available, please contact Principal or Chief of SAFE.

18.11. Non-Solicitation Policy

It is the policy of Monument Academy that employees may not engage in non-School business solicitation/distribution activities during work hours. In addition, the use of School resources (including but not limited to stationary, computers, email, voicemail, bulletin boards, and meeting facilities) for non-School business solicitation is also prohibited. Commercial ventures that wish to solicit faculty, staff, students, parents/guardians, or other members of the Monument Academy community may do so only with full written consent of the Principal in accordance with any school policies which may also apply.

19. ALCOHOL AND DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE

Monument Academy will not tolerate the presence of alcohol at the workplace during work hours. Residents may have alcohol in their quarters for consumption on days when students are not on the premises as long as it is double locked.

The School will not tolerate drug use at Monument Academy. The use, possession, distribution, or sale of controlled substances such as drugs or alcohol, or being under the influence of alcohol or controlled substances is strictly prohibited while on duty, which includes any overnight duty, while on School premises or driving for School purposes. If you need to take a prescription drug that affects your ability to perform your job duties, you are required to discuss possible accommodations with the COO or CEO. Employees found to be in violation of this policy will be subject to discipline, up to and including termination. Monument Academy reserves the right to require an employee to submit to drug testing in accordance with applicable law if Monument Academy reasonably suspects the employee is under the influence of drugs or alcohol while on duty, on School premises, or engaged in School related activities.

19.1. Smoke-Free Workplace Policy

Monument Academy is a smoke-free workplace. Monument Academy prohibits and will not tolerate smoking, vaping, or the use of any tobacco products in the workplace. This means that smoking is prohibited on all areas of the School's property and at any School-sponsored events,

without exception. Signs stating the policy will be clearly posted on the perimeter of the property, at entrances, and other prominent places. Employees found to be in violation of this policy will be subject to discipline, up to and including termination.

20. ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATION & INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY POLICY

The purpose of this policy is to protect the School's network and technology resources. The School provides its network in support of its educational mission. Use of the network is a privilege. As such, it is the responsibility of each employee to use these services appropriately and in compliance with all school, city, state, district and federal regulations. These policies are in addition to Monument Academy's Computer and Internet Usage Policy below, are not all-inclusive, and may be modified at any time. Violations of this policy may result in discipline, up to and including termination.

All Monument Academy employees are provided technological tools, email, and network accounts. All employees are expected to take care of all equipment and supplies provided to them. You are responsible for maintaining this material in proper working condition and promptly reporting any unsafe or improper functioning of this material to the Director of Data, Systems and IT.

IMPORTANT NOTE: PLEASE READ.

Neglect, theft, and/or destruction of School materials are grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including fees for replacement and/or termination of employment. School system computers, networks, and access are supplied to support Monument Academy's mission only. Use of electronic resources (hardware and software) must be in support of assigned responsibilities.

All electronic, telephonic, and communications transmitted by, received from, or stored in these systems are the property of Monument Academy. Users of such systems shall have no expectation of privacy. Monument Academy reserves the right to review, audit, intercept, access, and disclose all messages created, received, or sent over Monument Academy electronic communication systems, including, but not limited to, Monument Academy's hardware, software, programs, computers, email, cell phones, telephones, voicemail, facsimile, Internet systems, etc. Monument Academy also reserves the right to enter into any of these systems to inspect and review any and all data stored therein without notice to employees.

20.1. Computer and Internet Usage Policy

In regard to accessing the Internet, common sense and good judgment should prevail at all times. Files and communications hosted via Monument Academy services are private information of the School and its intended use is strictly for business purposes.

Any individuals using technology at Monument Academy expressly consent to monitoring of their activities. Anyone using the system in violation of the usage policy may be subject to disciplinary action, including possible discharge. Furthermore, employees could be exposed to civil and criminal liability. Monument Academy reserves the right to amend or modify this policy at any time as deemed necessary.

Monument Academy may use software to identify and block inappropriate Internet sites, including, but not limited to, sexually explicit sites. Such sites may be blocked from access by the School's network. In the event you nonetheless encounter inappropriate material while browsing on the Internet, immediately disconnect from the site, regardless of whether the site is subject to the School's blocking software. Material that is unlawful, including, but not limited to, illegal copies of software, music files, movie files or malware (malicious software, such as computer virus, Trojan horse, spyware, keyloggers, etc.), harassing, embarrassing, sexually explicit, profane, obscene, intimidating, defamatory, or otherwise offensive, including offensive material concerning sex, race, color, national origin, religion, age, disability, or other characteristic protected by law, or in violation of the School's equal employment opportunity policy and its policies against sexual or other harassment, may not be displayed, loaded, downloaded from the Internet, or stored on the School's computers. Employees encountering or receiving this kind of material should immediately report the incident to the Director of Data, Systems and IT or COO. The School's equal employment opportunity policy and its policies against sexual or other harassment apply fully to the use of the Internet and any violation of those policies may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination.

Employees may not illegally copy material protected under copyright law or make that material available to others for copying. You are responsible for complying with copyright law and applicable licenses that may apply to software, music files (.mp3, .wma, .rm, .ra, etc.), movie files (ripped copies of movies/videos to .avi, .mpg, .wmv, .mov, etc.), graphics, documents, messages, and other material you wish to download or copy. You may not agree to a license or download any material for which a registration fee is charged without first obtaining the express written permission of the School.

20.2. Electronic Mail Policy

The intention of this policy is created with an expectation that staff will use electronic mail responsibly. Monument Academy has established a policy with regard to access and disclosure of

electronic mail messages created, sent or received by School employees using the School's email system.

The School reserves and may exercise the right to review, audit, intercept, access and disclose all messages created, sent or received over the email system for any purpose (including texts, Google Hangouts, etc.). There should be no expectation of personal privacy or ownership of any email, including attachments, created, sent or received via, or stored on, the School email system. In other words, no one should send an email that he or she is not prepared to have viewed.

20.3. Social Media

Monument Academy recognizes that the internet provides unique opportunities to participate in interactive discussions and share information on particular topics using a wide variety of social media, such as Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter, Pinterest, Tumblr, blogs and wikis. However, employees' use of social media can pose risks to Monument Academy's confidential and proprietary information, students and families, and reputation as well as exposing Monument Academy to discrimination and harassment claims and jeopardizing our compliance with business rules and laws.

To minimize these risks, Monument Academy expects its employees to adhere to the following guidelines and rules regarding social media use. We intend for these guidelines to ensure that everyone, especially our students and families, feels safe and that the staff of Monument Academy conducts themselves in a professional manner that reflects well on themselves and the School. In order to contribute to a culture of support, trust and transparency, we urge employees to raise concerns within the School rather than engaging in social media to express their concerns or grievances. We strongly encourage employees to seek out administrators and ask for clarification whenever they are in doubt.

20.4. Personal Use of Social Media

Employees are expected to exercise good judgment and to act responsibly and professionally when using social media in the course of their personal lives. While the following guidelines are intended to assist employees with understanding their responsibilities, they cannot address every situation. When in doubt about whether a certain use of social media is appropriate, consult your supervisor.

Employees shall:

- Not speak poorly of Monument Academy

- Not “friend” students or communicate on public or private pages
- Not post pictures of students
- Think carefully before “friending” parents/guardians of students
- Direct all communication with students through that student’s parent unless that parent provides explicit approval to communicate directly with the student
- **Not use social media applications for personal use at work**

In addition to these specific expectations, Monument Academy encourages employees to keep in mind the following general guidelines when using personal social media:

1. Think twice before posting. Search engines can turn up posts years after they are created, and comments can be forwarded or copied. If you would not say it at a conference or to a member of the media, think twice about posting. If you are unsure about posting something or responding to a comment, ask your supervisor for input.
2. Don’t respond to negativity. Media matters are best handled by those authorized to speak on official Monument Academy social media channels. If you see positive or negative statements about Monument Academy or its students, families, teachers, or services that may deserve further attention, consider passing them along to the COO and CEO.
3. Think before you “friend.” Employees should be cautious about with whom they link or whom they “friend” on social media sites.
4. Strive for accuracy. Get things right the first time. Check facts and review content for spelling and grammatical errors before posting on social media.
5. Maintain workplace productivity. Personal social media is restricted from being used during work hours.

Reminder -- please use common sense. Online, the lines between public and private, personal and professional boundaries are blurred. You should consider whether the content associated with you is both consistent with the image you want to portray to your colleagues and consistent with these guidelines. While the School may encourage the use of technology to communicate School related matters with students and families, at the same time the School advises against interacting with students and their families, both current and former, in any personal, non-professional context. Furthermore, when posting something others may see online, the School urges all employees to use discretion and common sense.

This policy is not intended to preclude or dissuade employees from engaging in activities protected by state, district, or federal law, including the National Labor Relations Act, such as discussing wages, benefits or other terms and conditions of employment for employees' mutual

aid or protection.

21. GENERAL PROCEDURES FOR DEALING WITH THE MEDIA

The CEO and COO are the spokespeople for Monument Academy. No employee is to engage in conversation with any outlets of the media as a representative speaking on behalf of the School without explicit permission. Any violation will result in discipline, up to and including termination.

22. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Intellectual property shall include all artistic or intellectual works for which copyrights or trademarks may be acquired.

It is Monument Academy's policy to maintain ownership of intellectual property created through its educational or business activities, to the maximum extent possible. Monument Academy employees entering into agreements to create or make significant investments in intellectual or artistic works on behalf of Monument Academy should ensure that ownership of such work will vest in Monument Academy. The CEO and/or the Board of Trustees may make exceptions to this policy.

23. CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

During the course of your employment, you may have access to or become familiar with Monument Academy's proprietary information, trade secrets, and other non-public, confidential, or sensitive information (collectively, "Confidential Information"). Confidential Information includes, but is not limited to, confidential, proprietary, sensitive, or non-public information about Monument Academy's current, past, or contemplated business plans, transactions, relationships, know-how, market views, analyses, risk management strategies, marketing plans, investments, earnings, losses, finances, company documents, computer programs, databases, student and family information and documents, and operational models.

Some examples of confidential information include:

- Student information
- Financial information
- Knowledge of a termination
- Performance evaluation information
- Other information about Monument staff

It is Monument Academy's policy that all confidential information is considered proprietary and sensitive. You agree to maintain all such confidential information as confidential, and not to utilize, share, or disclose any such confidential information for any purpose, except as authorized in writing by Monument Academy. If you question whether certain information is considered confidential information, you should consult with your supervisor or the Human Resources Specialist or COO.

Employees of the School shall not, in any way, release any information about the School, its activities, its students or the activities of its personnel except (i) where the information is a matter of public record; (ii) or the employee has advance written consent of his/her supervisor or the CEO; or (iii) the employee is required to do so under applicable law.

Discussions involving sensitive information must always be held in confidential settings to safeguard the confidentiality of the information. Do not discuss confidential information in hallways, elevators, restrooms, restaurants, and other places where conversations might be overheard. Other practical guidelines for maintaining confidentiality and minimizing the risk of inadvertent disclosure include the following:

- Employees should remove confidential documents from conference rooms, copy machines, printers and other areas accessible to others after every meeting.
- Employees should store confidential documents in locked cabinets.
- Transmit documents in sealed envelopes marked "confidential," use confidential cover sheets, and, when appropriate, conspicuously designate confidential documents as "confidential."
- Employees should limit copying of, and access to, confidential documents to those with a legitimate need to examine or revise these documents.

No employee shall publish, disclose, use or authorize anyone else to publish, disclose, use, or in any way cause to be published, disclosed, or used any private or proprietary information which such employee may in any way acquire, learn, develop, or create by reason of employment with this school, unless otherwise provided by the CEO or required by law. Any document or other material containing such information is required to be returned to the CEO upon an employee's termination or resignation.

This policy reiterates our need for confidentiality in all aspects of employment. While employed at the School, employees may learn or work with and be entrusted with confidential and/or privileged information about fellow employees, administrations, school parents, students or applicants. Employees must exercise the highest degree of care not to disclose any such information, even inadvertently, to any unauthorized person in or outside of the School.

Confidential information includes, but is not limited to, the following examples:

- Student records

- Financial information
- Personnel records
- Payroll records
- Computer programs, codes, processes and passwords
- Personal information regarding school parents and students

An employee's obligations under this policy continue after his or her termination of employment. Upon termination of employment, all confidential information in the employee's possession must be returned to the School.

Nothing herein shall be deemed to limit an employee's right under the law including, without limitation, an employee's right to discuss the terms and conditions of his or her employment with colleagues or management or to provide information to any government agency in accordance with law.

24. MEDICAL TREATMENT

24.1. First-Aid and CPR Training

All employees are strongly encouraged to have a current First-Aid and CPR certification. All EDP staff members are required to attend a course offered at the school or obtain certification on their own. An employee will not be reimbursed for obtaining certification on his or her own unless such reimbursement is approved by the COO or Chief of Staff prior to signing up for the training.

24.2. Medication Administration

All medication will be administered and recorded by the designated medication administrators at each site. Medication will be kept in a locked storage cabinet. There is also a designated refrigerator for medication that must be kept cold. Under no circumstances will medication be given without a doctor's note. Children should never carry medication in their backpacks or lunch kits. Medication should always be checked-in by the trained medication administration staff member from the parent.

24.3. HIPAA-Protected Information

Confidential health and medical records are not included in your personnel file. The School will safeguard such records from disclosure and will divulge only that information: (1) as allowed by law, as referenced in the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA)

or other federal or state law; (2) to the employee's personal physician upon written request of the employee; (3) as required for Workers' Compensation cases; (4) on a need-to-know basis, in connection with matters in which the employee has put his or her health or ability to perform his or her job in issue; or (5) as otherwise required by law. Tuberculosis screening is required before the first day of employment and once every three years thereafter. All employees, substitute teachers, interns and volunteers must have a tuberculosis test. The current physician's statement must be on file in the Human Resource Office before the first day of school or the employee/volunteer's first day of work. Failure to provide documentation on time may result in immediate termination.

24.4. Peanut Free Workplace

Monument Academy is a peanut free school. There can be no peanuts or peanut products on School property.

25. REPORTING POLICY

Monument Academy requires all employees to observe high standards of business and personal ethics in the conduct of their duties and responsibilities. As employees and representatives of the School, we must practice honesty and integrity in fulfilling our responsibilities and comply with all applicable laws and regulations. The purpose of this policy is to encourage and enable good-faith reports by employees and others of observed or suspected misconduct or noncompliance with law or with Monument Academy's policies and procedures.

25.1. Reporting Responsibility

It is the responsibility of all employees to comply with Monument Academy policies and applicable law and to report violations or suspected violations of law or Monument Academy's policies in accordance with this Reporting Policy.

25.2. Reporting Violations

Monument Academy supports an open-door policy and suggests that employees share their questions, concerns, suggestions or complaints with their supervisor. In most cases, if you are not satisfied with your supervisor's response, you are encouraged to speak with the Human Resources Specialist, COO, CEO or anyone in management with whom you are comfortable approaching.

Leadership is required to report violations and suspected violations of Monument Academy

policies to Monument Academy's designated Compliance Officer, who has a specific responsibility to investigate reported violations. The COO has been designated as the Compliance Officer. If the violation or suspected violation involves the COO, employees may report the violation to the CEO. If the violation or suspected violation involved the CEO, the employee may report the violation to the Chair of the Board of Directors.

Anyone reporting a violation or suspected violation of Monument Academy policies must be acting in good faith and have reasonable grounds for believing the information disclosed indicates a violation of the policies. Any allegations that prove not to be substantiated and which prove to have been made maliciously or knowingly to be false will be viewed as a serious disciplinary offense.

This policy is not intended to supplant, but rather to complement and supplement, other Monument Academy policies. Thus, it does not affect any rights, responsibilities, or procedures set forth in other Monument Academy policies addressing misconduct. For example, reports, complaints or grievances such as those regarding discrimination or harassment should be made and addressed in accordance with Monument Academy's Equal Employment Opportunity and No Discrimination or Harassment policies and procedures.

25.3. Confidentiality

Violations or suspected violations may be submitted on a confidential basis by the complainant or may be submitted anonymously. Reports of violations or suspected violations will be kept confidential to the extent possible, consistent with the need to conduct an adequate investigation.

26. WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY

No employee who in good faith reports a violation under the Reporting Policy shall suffer harassment, retaliation or adverse employment consequences. An employee who retaliates against someone who has reported a violation under the Reporting Policy in good faith or who has participated in a review or inquiry conducted in response to such a report may result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination. This Whistleblower Policy is intended to encourage and enable employees and others to raise serious concerns within the School to promote a safe working environment.

27. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

The standard of behavior at Monument Academy is that all staff, volunteers, and board members avoid conflicts of interest between the interests of Monument Academy and the individual's personal, professional and business interests. The purposes of this policy are to protect the integrity of Monument Academy's decision-making process, to enable our constituencies to have

confidence in our integrity, and to protect the integrity and reputation of the School's staff, volunteers, and board members.

Employees should always act in the best interest of Monument Academy and not permit outside interests to interfere with their job duties. Monument Academy prohibits all employees from using their position with the School or Monument Academy's relationship with its families' vendors, suppliers, or contractors for private gain or to obtain benefits for themselves or members of their family.

For purposes of this policy, a potential conflict of interest occurs when an employee's outside interests (for example, financial or personal interests) interfere with Monument Academy's interests or the employee's work-related duties. For example, a conflict of interest can occur when an employee is in a position to influence a decision that may result in a personal gain for the employee or the employee's family member as a result of Monument Academy's business dealings. If you have a question about whether a situation is a potential conflict of interest, please contact the COO.

In the course of meetings or activities, individuals should disclose any interests in a transaction or decision where either the individual or his or her family or associates will receive a benefit or gain. Individuals should have an understanding that he or she will be asked to leave the room for the duration and will have no say or vote on the issue at hand.

28. WORK-RELATED GRIEVANCES

It is the policy of Monument Academy that all employees have the right to voice their complaints or grievances about matters pertaining to the school. Monument Academy recognizes the meaningful value and importance of full discussion in resolving conflicts, and in preserving good relations between employees. Accordingly, the following grievance procedure should be employed to ensure that complaints receive full consideration.

What May Be Grieved: This grievance process should be used to deal with complaints and concerns pertaining to educational environment, employment arrangements, or interpersonal conflicts.

Other Remedies: The existence of this procedure does not bar grievants from also filing claims in other forums to the extent permitted by district, state, or federal law.

Informal Grievance: Monument Academy believes that employees can resolve most problems that occur without damaging relationships. Employees should communicate with their supervisor any grievances they may have, and the supervisor will make a reasonable attempt to resolve the problem. When employees need to file a grievance about their supervisor, they should first try to discuss the matter and resolve it between them when possible. Supervisors should attempt to resolve any grievance as quickly as possible. If they're unable to do so, they should refer to the

Human Resources Department for support. If the grievance relates to a supervisor's behavior that can bring disciplinary action, employees should refer directly to the Human Resources Specialist or COO. If the problem is still not resolved, the employee may file a grievance with the CEO, and if not resolved then the Board of Directors pursuant to the Formal Grievance procedure below.

Formal Grievance: A grievant may file a written notice with the Board of Directors by submitting the written notice to the CEO, who will relay it to the Board of Directors. The written notice shall identify the nature of the complaint, the date(s) of occurrence, and the desired result, and shall be signed and dated by the person filing the grievance. Within twenty-one (21) days from receiving the written notice, the Board of Directors will respond in writing to the grievant as to the action taken and the reasons therefore.

This policy does not apply to complaints under Monument Academy's No Discrimination or Harassment and Equal Employment Opportunity policies or Monument Academy's Reporting Policy. Employees should follow the complaint reporting procedures under the No Discrimination or Harassment and Equal Employment Opportunity policies or Reporting Policy when reporting concerns or complaints under those policies.

29. PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

Depending on the severity or frequency of the disciplinary problem, a verbal or written reprimand, suspension with or without pay, disciplinary probation, or termination may be necessary. It is within the School's sole discretion to select the appropriate disciplinary action to be taken. Notwithstanding the availability of the various disciplinary options, nothing in this policy modifies an employee's status as an at-will employee.

The progressive discipline process will, in most instances, proceed by the following steps:

1. An official or unofficial verbal warning that is documented and placed in your personnel file;
2. A written, signed warning also placed in your personnel file;
3. Placement on a performance improvement plan and/or final warning;
4. Termination.

The School reserves the right to depart from the specific steps outlined above, up to and including the right to terminate an employee at its discretion, with or without cause or advance notice.

The following is not a complete list of offenses for which an employee may be subject to discipline, but it is illustrative of those offenses that may result in immediate discipline, up to and

including termination:

- Insubordination;
- Questionable judgment which puts students at risk;
- Harassment;
- Inappropriate conduct or communications with workers, students, or other individuals;
- Use, possession or being under the influence of alcohol or drugs while students are on campus;
- Weapon and firearm possession* on School property or during School business;
- Failure to report suspected child abuse or neglect, accidents or injuries.

*Weapons and firearms include, but are not limited to, unloaded as well as loaded rifles, pistols, or other portable guns (including any toys fashioned as a firearm or weapon), explosive devices, knives, or any other possession designated or used for inflicting bodily harm or physical damage. Possession includes having the item anywhere on School property, including in an automobile.

29.1. Criminal Arrests and Convictions

An employee must promptly notify the Human Resources Specialist and/or the COO of any arrest, admission to the commission of a crime, or conviction of a crime within 48 hours of its occurrence. Monument Academy will only consider such information for employment purposes in accordance with applicable law and to the extent that it negatively reflects upon the School or the employee's ability to perform his or her job functions.

Monument Academy reserves the right not to hire or retain anyone that has been convicted of a criminal offense in accordance with applicable law. Conviction of a crime that involves dishonesty may result in an automatic termination of employment. Before any decision is made, the nature of the crime and circumstances surrounding the conviction will be considered in accordance with applicable law.

30. PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND EVALUATION

We are committed to students reaching a high level of student achievement; in order to meet that commitment, we expect each employee to perform at the highest levels. To that end, we have implemented the following procedures:

30.1. Confidential Personnel File

The school shall maintain a confidential personnel file for each employee. The personnel file shall be maintained by the Human Resources Department, and shall be accessible to only the employee, Human Resources Specialist, Chief Operations Officer, and CEO. The Board of

Trustees may have access to the file to resolve an internal complaint brought by the employee. The Board of Trustees shall maintain and have full access to the personnel file of the CEO.

30.2. Strategic Professional Growth Plans

After establishing student achievement and organizational goals, staff members will develop individual strategic professional development plans. Each staff member and his or her supervisor will set the key strategies and objectives to help that staff member reach the goals for their individual strategic professional growth plans, using their job descriptions and organizational goals. All plans should identify specific strategies to achieve each goal, have timelines associated with each goal, and use metrics that will demonstrate the accomplishment of each goal.

Staff members will draft their initial strategic professional development plans before and during a goal setting meeting with their supervisor at the beginning of the year. There will be opportunities during the year to refine the goals, strategies, timelines, or metrics. For instance, after the goal setting meeting in the fall, teachers will meet with their supervisor quarterly after each interim assessment and will review their strategic professional development plans in light of the assessment results.

30.3. Observations

All staff members may be observed by their supervisors during the course of their responsibilities. Staff may receive verbal feedback or written feedback from their supervisor in the areas of improvement outlined in their performance plan and any of the other areas outlined in their job responsibilities. Supervisors will make every effort to provide prompt and specific feedback.

30.4. Evaluations

All staff members will receive a formal written evaluation at the end of each year. This will be preceded by an informal mid-year evaluation. The evaluations will address both strengths and areas for growth.

For non-instructional staff members, the evaluations will focus on the employee's performance relevant to his/her job.

If a supervisor has significant concerns about the effectiveness of a staff member during the year, the supervisor may meet with the staff member to discuss performance expectations, highlight problem areas, and develop a performance plan. In addition, the supervisor may initiate progressive discipline as stated in that section below.

31. PURCHASING POLICY

31.1. Purchases from School Funds

All staff must follow stated procedures for purchasing materials, services, and supplies. Staff members must have authorization from his or her supervisor before making a purchase for the school. Without such authorization, no reimbursement should be expected. Staff members approved to carry a school credit card must sign the authorization form agreeing to only make school-related purchases and submit all receipts monthly for justified purchases. Staff members must work proactively with the COO or designee to ensure timely ordering, proper payment and/or prompt reimbursement. All materials and supplies purchased with school funds are the property of Monument Academy Public Charter School.

31.2. Discretionary Funds

Staff may be granted discretionary funds to use in fulfillment of their roles as part of the School's annual budget. Staff will be expected to plan their expenditures for the school year with guidance from his or her supervisor, make purchases in accordance with the stated procedures, and monitor the current balance in his or her budget. All materials and supplies purchased with discretionary funds are the property of Monument Academy Public Charter School.

31.3. Travel and Expenses

The School will reimburse employees for reasonable expenses incurred on behalf of Monument Academy or while on a trip for School business if and only if the trip has been approved by the employee's supervisor. Supervisors may only approve trips that are in the annual budget or expressly approved by the CEO or COO.

32. FACULTY AND STAFF HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Faculty and Staff Handbook and I understand that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies contained in the Faculty and Staff Handbook and any revisions made to it. I further acknowledge that the Faculty and Staff Handbook supersedes all prior oral or written statements by Monument Academy Public Charter School concerning its employment policies, guidelines and benefits.

I understand and agree that Monument Academy Public Charter School reserves the right to change, modify, or delete any of the information, policies, and benefits described in the Faculty

and Staff Handbook at any time, with or without notice, except to the policy of employment-at-will. All such changes will be communicated through official notices, and I understand that revised information may supersede, modify, or eliminate existing policies. Only Monument Academy Public Charter School has the ability to adopt any revisions to the policies in this Faculty and Staff Handbook.

I acknowledge that the Faculty and Staff Handbook contains Monument Academy Public Charter School's Family and Medical Leave policy. I understand that the policy advises me of the steps the company has taken to comply with the Family and Medical Leave Act of 1993, 29 U.S.C. § 2601, et seq., and the D.C. Family and Medical Leave Act of 1990, D.C. Code § 32-501, et seq., as well as my rights and obligations under those laws. I also understand that I may contact Monument Academy Public Charter School's Principal or CEO for further information about Monument Academy Public Charter School's Family and Medical Leave policy.

Furthermore, I understand and agree that the Faculty and Staff Handbook is neither a contract of employment nor a legal document, and my employment with Monument Academy Public Charter School is at-will and of no definite duration. Nothing contained in the Faculty and Staff Handbook or any oral representations alter the at-will status of this employment relationship.

I also understand that Monument Academy Public Charter School reserves the right to modify or alter my position, in its sole discretion, with or without cause or advance notice, through actions other than termination, including demotion, promotion, transfer, reclassification or reassignment. I further understand that no express or implied promise or guarantee with regard to the duration of my employment, wages or benefits is binding upon Monument Academy Public Charter School unless made in writing and duly executed by the Board of Trustees of Monument Academy Public Charter School and explicitly and specifically identified as an employment agreement or contract.

The Faculty and Staff Handbook describes important information about my employment with Monument Academy Public Charter School and I understand that if I have any questions regarding any materials contained in, or not answered by, the Faculty and Staff Handbook, I should consult with the CEO or COO..

Your electronic signature is acknowledgement of receipt of this Handbook.